GOVERNANCE STARTER KIT

Six artifacts, filled in

From "90 Days to a Decision-Ready Technology Portfolio" · Reginal Campbell, PMP

> From competing engineering priorities to accountable decisions, credible roadmaps and measurable delivery.

Every artifact in this kit supports a decision, and every one uses the same sample portfolio and numbers:

Program	Sponsor	Budget	Why it matters
A. AI-assisted sourcing pilot	VP, Sourcing Solutions	$1.2M	Recommends savings opportunities to sourcing analysts. Adoption is the test.
B. Spend analytics release	VP, Analytics Products	$900K	Launch date committed to customers: Week 16.
C. Supplier and contract data platform	VP, Data Platform	$600K	Feeds A and B. Audit fieldwork starts Week 18.

Illustrative scenario set in healthcare supply chain and spend technology. One 8-person integration engineering team, planned at 75% focus time, serves B and C. On Day 47 the shared RAID log shows both booking it for Weeks 10–15. The artifacts follow that conflict from first signal to executive decision.

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All programs, people, figures and decisions in the scenario are illustrative. It is set in healthcare supply chain and spend technology and informed by public information about the industry; it does not describe actual Vizient initiatives, systems or plans. The plan is a starting hypothesis I would test against the real portfolio in the first 30 days. The evidence section describes my own work and is drawn from my published case study.

Decision rights matrix ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 1

For: Everyone in governance. When: Set at Day 30; reviewed at the retro. Supports: Who owns each yes and no.

R does the work · A decides (one per row) · C consulted · I informed

Decision	Exec Sponsor	Steering	TPM Director	Program Lead	Shared-Resource Owner	Control Owner	Business Owner
Scope change within one program	I	I	C	**A/R**	C	C	C
Scope change affecting another program	I	**A**	R	C	C	C	C
Budget change within tolerance	I	I	**A**	R			C
Budget change over tolerance	C	**A**	R	C		C	I
Schedule slip within tolerance		I	**A**	R	C		I
Schedule slip over tolerance	C	**A**	R	C	C		C
Shared resource conflict between programs	I	**A**	R	C	C		I
Risk acceptance (security, privacy, compliance)	C	I	R	C		**A**	I
Go-live approval	I	C	R	R		C	**A**
Pause or stop a program	**A**	R	R	C	I	C	C

> Go-live belongs to the business owner, not IT. Delivery proves readiness; the business decides to launch.

Stoplight status card: no watermelon statuses ILLUSTRATIVE

For: Everyone who reports or reads status. When: Set at Day 30. Supports: What every color means.

A watermelon status is green on the outside and red on the inside. These criteria make status a measurement, not a mood. Thresholds shown are for Tier 1 programs. Tier 2 tolerances are twice as wide. Security, privacy and compliance issues have no tolerance at any tier.

	Green	Yellow	Red
Schedule	Milestones within 5 business days of plan	Forecast slip of 6 days to 2 weeks	Forecast slip over 2 weeks
Budget	Within 5% of plan	5% to 10% variance	Over 10% variance
Scope	Baseline unchanged, or changes approved	A change is pending a decision inside the program	A change affects another program or the business outcome
Resources	Committed people available in their window	A gap the program can cover itself	A gap that needs people from another program
Risk	No open high-severity risks	A high-severity risk with an owner and a mitigation	No viable mitigation, or a control failure
What it means	Proceed.	Recoverable inside the program. A named owner has a recovery date.	Recovery needs a decision at steering.

FOUR RULES

1. No surprise reds: material risks are escalated at the earliest credible warning.
2. Critical control failures and security incidents go red immediately, whether or not they were yellow first.
3. Every yellow has an owner and a recovery date. A yellow without both is reported as red.
4. Status describes the forecast, not just today. Anyone can challenge a color by pointing to the criteria.

ESCALATION THRESHOLDS

A shared team is unavailable in its committed window	TPM Director, then Steering	1 business day
A milestone is at risk (over 2 weeks)	Steering	Next steering, or called within 5 business days
Budget variance (over 10%)	Steering	Next steering
Security, privacy or compliance issue	Control Owner and Exec Sponsor	24 hours

RAID log excerpt, as of Day 52 ILLUSTRATIVE

For: Program leads, shared-resource and control owners. When: Live; reviewed every two weeks. Supports: What needs escalating, and when.

ID	Type	Program	Description	Owner	Impact	Status	Next action
R-011	Risk	A	Sourcing analysts not completing training before pilot wave 2	Business Owner, A	Adoption below target	Yellow	Add side-by-side support sessions, Day 55
D-004	Dependency	A → C	A's sourcing recommendations need C's normalized supplier data before pilot wave 2	Program Lead, C	A's wave 2 slips if C's data slips	Yellow	Confirm data readiness date, Day 58
A-006	Assumption	C	Contract feeds from the two legacy source systems map cleanly to the new data contracts	Program Lead, C	3 weeks of rework if wrong	Yellow	Mapping proof of concept, Day 57
I-007	Issue	B / C	Integration engineering is committed to B (960 hrs) and C (720 hrs) in Weeks 10–15. Capacity is 1,440 hrs: a 240-hour shortfall.	TPM Director	B's launch date or C's audit readiness	Red	Steering 2 decision, Day 60
R-013	Risk	C	Audit fieldwork in Week 18 finds contract-pricing data without complete access controls or lineage	Control Owner	Audit finding	Yellow	Tied to the outcome of I-007
R-009	Risk	B	Reconciling spend figures to source contracts takes longer than planned	Program Lead, B	1 to 2 week launch slip	Green	Reconciliation underway; track weekly

I-007 was logged as risk R-012 on Day 47, became an issue on Day 48 under the 1-business-day rule, and went to steering because the fix needs people from another program.

Steering pre-read · Steering 2, Day 60 ILLUSTRATIVE

For: Steering members. When: Three business days before each steering. Supports: The one decision on the agenda.

DECISION REQUESTED

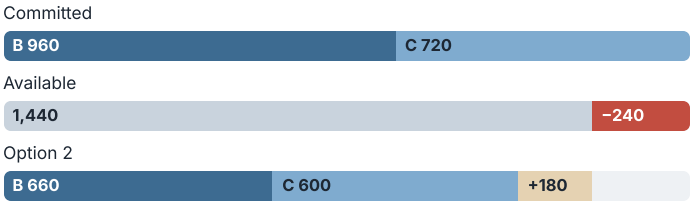
Choose how to resolve the integration engineering conflict between Program B and Program C in Weeks 10–15.

SITUATION

- The 8-person integration team is committed to Program B's launch (960 hours) and Program C's controls and migration work (720 hours) in the same six weeks.
- Capacity is planned at 75% focus time, to allow for meetings, support and time off: 8 engineers × 40 hours × 6 weeks × 75% = 1,440 hours. The shortfall is 240 hours.
- B's Week 16 launch date is committed to customers. C's access controls and data lineage for contract-pricing data must be in place before audit fieldwork starts in Week 18.

Both plans assumed the team's full availability. Neither could see the other's peak. The shared RAID log is what surfaced it, on Day 47.

INTEGRATION ENGINEERING, WEEKS 10–15 (HOURS)



OPTIONS

OPTION 1

Sequence delivery

Finish B first, then C.

Hours
B 960; C deferred

Schedule
B holds. C slips about 6 weeks.

Cost
None added

Risk
Audit finding likely: C's controls miss Week 18. A's pilot also waits on C's data.

Reversible?
Yes, but the audit consequence is not.

OPTION 2 · RECOMMENDED

Phase scope

B launches with core scope; two non-critical features (scheduled exports, benchmark drill-down, 300 hours) follow by Week 20. C does its audit-critical work first: access controls and lineage for contract-pricing data. Its non-audit feed migrations (120 hours) follow after Week 16.

Hours
B 660 + C 600 = 1,260 (180-hour buffer)

Schedule
B's date holds. C's audit-critical work holds. The rest of C follows after Week 16.

Cost
None added

Risk
The business owner launches with less scope. Customers get two features four weeks later.

Reversible?
Yes. Deferred scope ships by Week 20.

OPTION 3

Add capacity

Two contract integration engineers for six weeks.

Hours
1,440 + about 360 productive contract hours (480 billed): 120-hour buffer

Schedule
Both hold, if onboarding takes under 2 weeks.

Cost
About $72K: 12% of C's budget, over the 10% threshold

Risk
Onboarding uses a third of the window. Knowledge of the contract-data model leaves with the contractors.

Reversible?
Partly. Spend is committed.

RECOMMENDATION

Option 2. It protects both external commitments at no added cost and leaves a 180-hour buffer. I'd get contractor pricing now as a fallback, to decide by Day 74 if the buffer is used up.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- **Business Owner, B:** Accept the reduced launch scope and the Week 20 follow-up.
- **Control Owner:** Confirm the audit-critical scope matches what the auditors will test.
- **Steering:** Approve Option 2 and the fallback trigger.

If we don't decide on Day 60: The team starts Week 10 double-booked. Work goes to whoever asks loudest, and both commitments are at risk.

Executive one-pager · Day 90 ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 5

For: Exec sponsor and business owners. When: Each executive readout. Supports: Proceed, pivot, slow or stop.

DECISION NEEDED

Approve Proceed for Program B's Week 16 launch with core scope. Approve Slow for Program A's pilot wave 3 until adoption reaches target.

Program	Status	Confidence	Trend	One line
A. AI-assisted sourcing pilot	Yellow	Medium	→	Delivered on time; analyst adoption is short of target.
B. Spend analytics release	Green	High	↑	Release readiness criteria met. Deferred features on track for Week 20.
C. Supplier and contract data platform	Green	Medium	↑	Audit-critical controls 85% complete. On track for Week 18.

VALUE AT RISK

If A's adoption stalls, the sourcing savings the pilot identified won't be captured at scale for about a quarter.

TOP THREE RISKS

1. A's adoption: 70% of wave 1–2 analysts active, against an 80% target. Owner: Business Owner, A.
2. C's legacy feed mapping passed for one of two source systems; the second needs a workaround. Owner: Program Lead, C.
3. B's spend reconciliation is on track; the fallback date is held. Owner: Program Lead, B.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE STEERING 2

Option 2 was carried out. The contractor fallback wasn't needed and was closed on Day 74. C moved from yellow to green.

DELIVERY

9 of 10

milestones on time; decision turnaround averages 3 days

ADOPTION

70%

of A's analysts active, against an 80% target

OPERATIONAL

99.9%

data refreshes on time; support tickets trending down

THE FOUR CALLS

Proceed: criteria met and controls in place. **Pivot:** the evidence favors a different approach. **Slow:** capacity or adoption is short, so scope is sequenced. **Stop:** criteria still unmet after one revision.

Decision log, Days 1–90 ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 6

For: Everyone in governance, and the teams the decisions affect. When: Updated within 24 hours of each decision. Supports: What was decided, on what evidence, and when to revisit it.

#	Day	Forum	Decision	Decided by	Basis	Revisit if
001	30	Steering 1	Approved the governance charter, decision rights and cadence.	Steering	Stakeholder intake; portfolio inventory	Governance retro at Day 90
002	30	Steering 1	Adopted the stoplight status criteria, tiered by risk, and escalation thresholds.	Steering	Inconsistent status formats found in intake	Two or more color disputes in a month
003	41	Program review	Moved A's pilot wave 2 by one week to finish analyst training (within tolerance).	TPM Director	R-011; slip under 2 weeks	Training completion below 90%
004	48	TPM escalation	Paused new requests to integration engineering until Steering 2.	TPM Director	I-007; 1-business-day rule	Steering 2 decision
005	60	Steering 2	Approved Option 2: phased scope for B, audit-critical scope first for C.	Steering, with B's business owner	Pre-read options analysis	Buffer falls below 80 hours
006	74	Steering	Contractor fallback not needed; closed.	Steering	Buffer at 150 hours	None
007	90	Executive Readout	Proceed: B launches Week 16. Slow: A's pilot wave 3 waits until adoption reaches 80%.	Exec Sponsor and business owners	Readiness criteria; scorecard	Adoption at 80% for two weeks running

The "Revisit if" column is the point: a decision should change when the evidence changes, and everyone should know in advance what evidence that is.

> A recommendation should change when the evidence changes. Accountability for delivery should not.